

How a question works

A question is a request for information. It usually has a short answer. When Sue asks, "How was your day?", she is asking for a general summary, roughly the length of a weather forecast. She is not asking for the 1st, the 2nd, the drive on the 3rd that "should have been a birdie chance", or the 7th.

The Programme recommends the following method. Hear the question. Give an answer of no more than two sentences. Ask a question back, and then listen to the answer to that question, even if it is about the neighbours' extension.